

KARUSELKA

USER GUIDE

V1.4.1 - BLENDER 3.6+ / 4.2+

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KARUSELKA is a fast turntable rig for Blender. Pick an object, press Create Rig - a camera orbits it on linear keyframes, ready to scrub or render as a showreel turntable. Two modes: the camera orbits the object, or the object spins under a static camera. Pairs with LAMPOCHKA: a light preset + a KARUSELKA turntable = a model showcase in two minutes.

github.com/abyrvalg379/karuselka

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1. ABOUT KARUSELKA

Key features:

- one click: Create Rig builds the rig and keyframes, working immediately;
- two modes: Camera - the camera orbits the object; Object - the object spins, camera static;
- constant rotation speed: interpolation is forced LINEAR, no ease-in-out on a turntable;
- shot presets Front / Three-Quarter / Top / Hero in one click, plus your own .json presets;
- output presets: resolution, samples and format (PNG frames / MP4 / WebM) for the render;
- collection assembly: the turntable covers a model built of many objects - bbox, radius and center across everything inside;
- live parameters: Frames, Rounds, Radius and Height change without rebuilding the rig;
- clean teardown: Remove Rig removes only what KARUSELKA created - your scene is untouched.

2. INSTALLATION

- Blender 4.2+: download karuselka_extension.zip from the latest release github.com/abyrvalg379/karuselka - Preferences - Get Extensions - Install from Disk.
- Blender 3.6-4.1: same release, file karuselka_legacy.zip, via Preferences - Add-ons - Install.
- The panel appears in the 3D viewport N-panel (N key) - KARUSELKA tab.

3. QUICK START

- Select an object (or set the Target on the panel).
- Press Create Rig - the camera is already orbiting; scrub the timeline.
- Framing: shot presets Front / Three-Quarter / Top / Hero, or set Start Angle and Height by hand.
- Press Render Turntable - frames land in //turntable/ as <asset>_turntable.
- Remove the rig with Remove Rig when it is no longer needed.

4. RIG AND MODES

4.1 Camera and Object

Mode Camera: the camera flies around the object - the classic showcase. Mode Object: the object spins on its axis, the camera stays still. In Object mode the model hierarchy root is parented to KARUSELKA_Empty (if the target already has a parent, the top of its parent chain is parented); Remove Rig restores the hierarchy with world transforms preserved.

4.2 What gets framed: Target and Collection

Target - the turntable object (the active object by default). The Collection field switches the rig to a root collection: bbox, auto-radius and rotation center are computed across every object inside - the turntable of a multi-part model covers it as a whole.

4.3 Orbit parameters

PARAMETER	MEANING
Frames	frames per full revolution; fps comes from the scene
Rounds	number of revolutions, fractional allowed
Dir	rotation direction as seen from above
Start Angle	orbit angle at frame 1 (Front preset = -90)
Center	rotation center: middle of the scope bbox or the 3D cursor
Radius	orbit distance; 0 = auto: scope size × Margin
Margin	auto-radius multiplier (2.5 by default) - the camera never crowds the model
Height	camera height relative to the object center

Edits to Frames / Rounds / Dir rebuild the rig live: the last keyframe slides to the new end and the timeline follows - no rebuild needed. Radius, Margin and Height move the camera immediately as well.

4.4 Camera

The rig camera becomes the scene camera (Numpad 0 and render); with your own camera KARUSELKA aims it at the target. Lens, DoF and near/far clip are edited right on the panel and applied immediately. Auto clip keeps a fixed 1000:1 ratio - small and large models frame without depth-buffer artifacts. Every Create Rig starts from clean defaults; the Keep Settings switch inherits the previous camera settings instead.

5. SHOT PRESETS

Four built-in presets set the start angle and the camera height as a fraction of the orbit radius - one click each: Front, Three-Quarter, Top, Hero. The current rig settings are saved to .json with Save Preset into the folder from Preferences (Presets Folder); files are picked up live and appear on the panel as user presets.

6. RENDERING THE TURNTABLE

Render Turntable - a non-blocking animation render. Output presets are applied for the duration of the render:

PRESET	OPTIONS
Resolution	Square 1080 / 1080p / 1440p / 4K / 2048x858 / Scene (leave untouched)
Samples	Draft / Normal / High / Scene
Format	PNG frames / MP4 / WebM

- frames and files land in //turntable/ next to the .blend; the path is changed by the Output field;
- the turntable is named <asset>_turntable automatically (asset = the .blend file name; fallback - collection or target);
- if the scene has no lights, the panel warns before starting;
- Create Rig and Render Turntable set the scene range to 1..N themselves; engine, samples and format outside the presets are never touched.

7. REMOVE RIG

Removes only what KARUSELKA created: the rig, the empty and the keyframes. Your camera stays, the previous scene camera returns. In Object mode the model hierarchy is un-parented back with world transforms preserved. The rig is always single: a repeated Create Rig rebuilds the existing one instead of stacking copies.

8. WORKFLOWS

Model showcase in two minutes

LAMPOCHKA: apply a light preset. KARUSELKA: Create Rig, the Three-Quarter preset, Render Turntable to MP4. Done.

Spin instead of orbit

Mode Object: the model rotates in place - handy for marketplace listings and standard 360-degree loops.

Turntable of a multi-part model

A model of a dozen objects? Point at the Collection - radius and center are computed across the assembly, nothing clips or drifts.

Client frame before the render

Scrub the timeline with live shot presets: Front for the head-on view, Hero for the dramatic angle - show the client right in the viewport.

9. TROUBLESHOOTING

SYMPTOM	CAUSE	WHAT TO DO
The camera skips a stretch of the orbit	keyframes are not on linear interpolation	KARUSELKA always sets LINEAR; if you edited the curves by hand - recreate the rig
The object clips out of frame	the radius is small for the model size	raise Margin or set Radius manually; for an assembly point at the Collection
The render is empty / dark	no lights in the scene or the wrong camera	the panel warns about lights; check that the rig camera is active (Numpad 0)
Need the scene resolution back	output presets apply for the duration of the render	pick the Scene preset - scene settings stay untouched
Want your own camera back	the rig camera became active on Create Rig	Remove Rig returns the previous active camera and removes only its own
Did a second Create Rig stack a duplicate?	it does not: the rig is always single	a repeated Create Rig rebuilds the rig from the current settings